NITA AMBANI WALKS INTO HER OFFICE at the eponymous Nita Mukesh Ambani Cultural Centre (NMACC) dressed in a radiant red Banarasi sari from Reliance Retail's homegrown label Swadesh. "Everything in here is Made-in-India," says Ambani, "except for the TV (that's Japanese)." Among the treasures is an N.S. Bendre painting, the very first work she bought after marriage in 1986, and an ornate Pichhwai-painted *pankha* (fan) installed on the ceiling.

In between shooting for INDIA TODAY, she has been prepping for the annual day celebrations of Dhirubhai Ambani International School (it's the first since the pandemic, she says) and the IPL auction in Dubai (RIL owns the Mumbai Indians franchise). And then there's the charitable work with the Reliance Foundation and planning for the next big production to bring and create at the NMACC.

"All women are multitaskers," says Ambani. "Whatever my boys Akash and Anant can do, my daughter Isha can do as well. I firmly believe that what women cannot do, cannot be done."

The NMACC is the culmination of a dream that Ambani has had for long—a performing arts space in India that would be the envy of the world. "I took a little bit of every space I visited the world over and stored it in my head," she says. It captures her passion for the arts, one that dates back to her childhood when she learned Bharatanatyam, and later as an actor in her student days at the Narsee Monjee college. Acting was set aside, but dancing is still in her blood as she makes time to practise.

The NMACC along with the Reliance Foundation, RIL's philanthropic arm that she started in 2010, has enabled Nita Ambani to support both artisans and performing artists. "It has been such a wonderful experience to interact with them," she says. "They face so many hardships and are pursuing and keeping alive India's heritage. For me, to take our Indian art and culture globally is something I am really looking forward to."

Once a nursery teacher, her other passion project is setting up Reliance Foundation schools. Sports have also been a priority. A member of the International Olympic Committee, for now, she has her sights set on bringing the Youth Olympics and ultimately the Summer Games to India. Culture, education, rural transformation, health, women's empowerment and sports, and then there's her four grandchildren. Nita Ambani has her hands full. ■

–Suhani Singh



OF BODY AND MIND

"You can achieve anything with dedication, hard work and passion, but remember to spend some time on your physical and emotional wellbeing"

HOWZZAT! An IOC member, she hosted its session in Mumbai in October, which saw the inclusion of cricket in the 2028 Olympics

ACCOMPLISHMENT

Has put India on the international cultural spaces map with state-of-the-art NMACC